

# PART 1 — BREAKOUT GAME

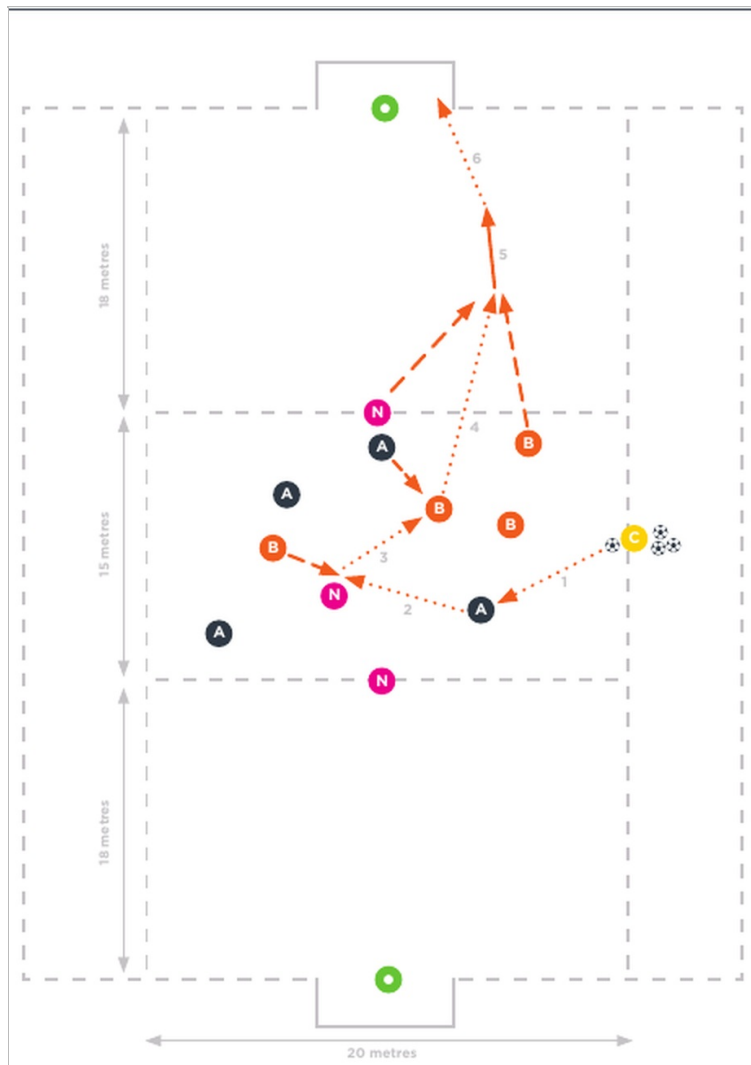
Counter-Attacking | Arrow Soccer | Phase 1 of 3

Age U12-U16 • Area 18-yard box to 18-yard box, 20m wide

Zones Thirds of 18m / 15m / 18m

Numbers 4v4 + 3 neutrals + 2 GKs

## PART 1



Team B steal in the central zone and break out to attack 2v1 against the nearest neutral.

## HOW IT RUNS

- Long, narrow pitch set up between the two 18-yard boxes and split into thirds.
- Two teams of four start in the middle third with three neutrals (N) — one in the middle third, one on each edge of it.
- The coach (C) plays into the possession team, Team A, who try to string **10 consecutive passes** for a point.
- The three neutrals support Team A for an overload. The end neutrals are fixed and become defenders if Team B steals it; the middle neutral moves anywhere in the central area.
- Team B press to steal. On the win they break out of the central area and attack **2v1** against the nearest neutral, finishing in the nearest goal.
- Steal and score → the coach feeds a new ball to their remaining players in the central zone to attack the other goal.
- Ball out, or the press fails to score → the coach feeds the possession team again and play continues.
- Swap roles after each three-minute working block.

## COACHING DETAIL — IN POSSESSION

- **Composure:** quality passing and receiving under aggressive pressure.
- **Quick combination play:** one and two touch keeps the pressing team from stealing it.
- **Disguised passing:** disguise reduces the defenders' ability to read play and intercept.

## COACHING DETAIL — OUT OF POSSESSION

- **Protect central areas:** the pressing team forces play into wide areas where space is limited.
- **Pressing triggers:** poor or miscontrolled passes, slow ball speed.
- **Press as a team:** the four hunt the ball together — restricts space and applies maximum pressure.
- **"Smother or recover":** recognise when to press and when to drop and regain shape.
- **Attacking transition:** know when to drive at the defender 1v1 and when to combine for the 2v1 — at match tempo.

## PART 2 — ATTACKING / DEFENDING WAVE GAME

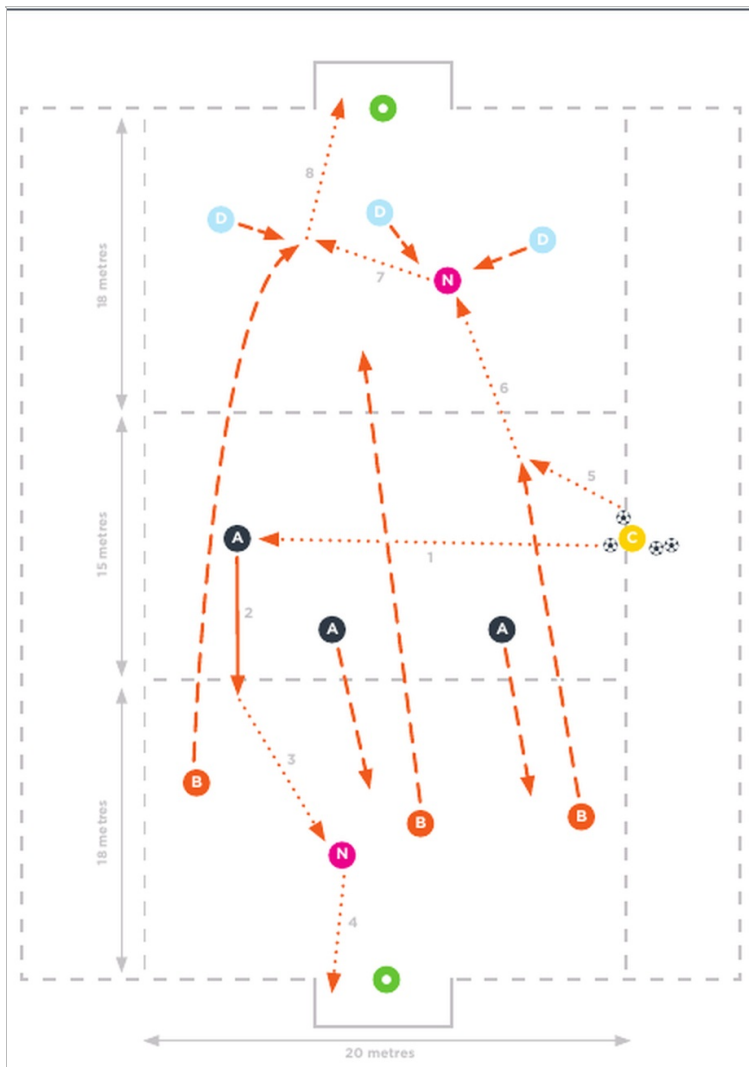
Counter-Attacking | Arrow Soccer | Phase 2 of 3

**Age** U12-U16 • **Area** Same as Part 1

## Overload 4v3 in every attack

**Numbers** 3 teams of 3 + 2 locked neutrals + GKs

## PART 2



*Team A attack one goal; the team beside it gets out fast to defend. Neutral makes it 4v3.*

## HOW IT RUNS

- Played in the same working area. Team A start in the central third; Teams B and D start next to the goal in their end thirds.
- A neutral (N) is locked in each end third and plays for whichever team is attacking there.
- The coach plays into Team A, who attack either goal. As soon as they commit, the team beside that goal **gets out fast** to defend.
- Team A plus the neutral attack with a **4v3 overload** and look to score.
- Attack over → Team A become the resting defenders. Team B take a new ball and attack the opposite goal against Team D.
- Team B then rest, and Team D attack the far end against Team A. The rotation continues for a set working period.
- If the defending team win it, they counter to the opposite goal as quickly as possible. The attacking team may recover and win it back **until the halfway line** — after that they must let the counter go.

## COACHING DETAIL — IN POSSESSION

- **"Run hard with the ball":** drive at goal and force the defenders to decide — hold or press.
- **Forward runs off the ball:** runs beyond the first defender create through balls, or drag defenders out as decoys.
- **Individual attacking:** even with the overload, use tricks, skills and space to attack 1v1 when the space is there.
- **Create space to shoot:** 1v1 or quick combination — find the shooting chance as often as possible.

## COACHING DETAIL – OUT OF POSSESSION

- **Limit space by halving the pitch:** force the ball wide and get numbers around it to steal.
- **Cover & balance:** as the first defender presses, second and third cover to kill the forward pass — talk throughout.
- **Delay or steal:** when underloaded, recognise when to go and win it and when to hold, delay and force outside.

# PART 3 — THEMED DIRECTIONAL GAME

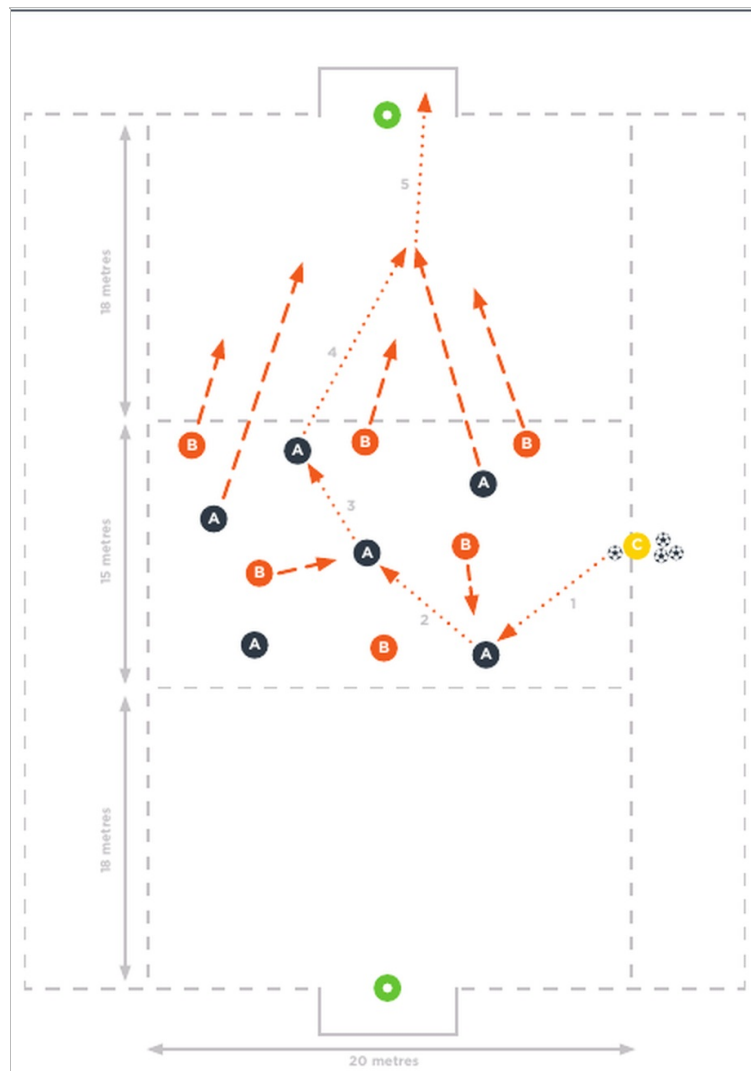
Counter-Attacking | Arrow Soccer | Phase 3 of 3

Age U12-U16 • Area Same as Parts 1 and 2

Theme Receive centrally, counter fast

Numbers 6v6 + GKs • Offsides in play

## PART 3



Coach serves into the central third; 3v3 attacking and defending scenarios break out in an end third.

## HOW IT RUNS

- Directional themed game on the same pitch, two teams of six plus goalkeepers. All 12 outfield players start in the central third.
- The coach (C) always serves into the central third to begin. After the serve, no one is locked into a third.
- Once the first pass is made, **three players** from the team in possession attack their designated goal while **three defenders** drop into the defensive third.
- If a team scores, the coach feeds their remaining attackers in the central area. Everyone from the previous phase works back quickly.
- Ball out or no goal → the coach passes to the opposite team, who attack 3v3 the other way; the previous attackers and defenders make fast recovery runs back to the central area.
- **Progression:** add a fourth attacker — and a recovering fourth defender — as the practice develops.
- Offsides are in play throughout. Play for a set period at the coach's discretion.

## COACHING DETAIL — IN POSSESSION

- **"Quick or careful":** on the steal, recognise whether to counter into space or be patient and move the defence first.
- **Direct play:** mostly a final-third game — be direct on and off the ball, and stay creative.
- **Underlaps / overlaps:** even in a narrow area, these runs cause confusion and create space.

## COACHING DETAIL — OUT OF POSSESSION

- **Defending 1v1:** this game lends itself to wide 1v1s — body shape sends the attacker where you want him.
- **Recognise the chance to steal:** delay and force wide first, then punish a heavy touch or slow ball speed.
- **Hold the line:** offsides are in play, so communicate and keep the defensive line level.